

UNIVERSITY OF ESSEX

Undergraduate Examinations 2021

CURRENT DISPUTES IN SOCIOLOGY: SOCIOLOGICAL ANALYSIS III

Time allowed: 24 hours

Please see your exam timetable or check on FASER for the deadline to upload your answer.

The times shown on your timetable are in British Summer Time (BST). Please check online for a conversion to your local time if you will be undertaking your assessment outside the United Kingdom

INSTRUCTIONS

Candidates must answer **THREE** questions: **ONE** from **SECTION A**, **ONE** from **SECTION B** and **ONE** from **EITHER** Section.

Candidates must answer **THREE** questions in total.

The paper consists of **EIGHTEEN** questions in total.

All questions are of equal weight.

You may write up to 2250 words for this paper, a suggested 750 per question.

These questions have been set so that you can answer them within the normal exam time frame which is three hours. You are not expected to spend 24 hours on this assessment.

Referencing and plagiarism

You may consult resources for this take-home exam. You are NOT expected to provide a bibliography.

You must avoid copying from text books, articles, online sources or your own previous work. If you do quote, you must use quotation marks and provide in-text references. Penalties for plagiarism will apply.

You are reminded that collaborating with other students is collusion, which is also an academic offence. Penalties will apply.

Submission

If you have a query with the content of this exam paper contact socugrad@essex.ac.uk

If you have a technical problem with FASER, or any other query, please go to [Exams Website](#) to find contact details of the teams that can help you.

Please note that the time allocated for this assessment includes time for you to download this question and answer paper and to upload your question and answers paper to FASER.

Please allow at least 30 minutes at the end of your exam time to upload your work. Once you have completed the assessment do not leave it to the last minute to upload.

Please save your work throughout the examination to avoid losing your work. **You must only submit Microsoft Word documents.**

Please do not communicate with any other candidate in any way during this assessment. Your response must be your own work. Procedures are in place to detect plagiarism and collusion.

Candidates must answer **THREE** questions: **ONE** from **SECTION A**, **ONE** from **SECTION B** and **ONE** from **EITHER** Section.

SECTION A:

1. Outline and assess the positivist approach to producing sociological knowledge.
2. Can interpretation provide a basis for sociological knowledge?
3. Does modernity have its roots in colonialism? If so, what are the implications for how we think of modernity?
4. “Inequalities in language represent inequalities in the world”. Critically explain this statement.
5. What did Barthes mean when he argued that popular culture is ideological? How convincing do you find his approach?
6. Critically explain the role that Bourdieu gave to habitus in explaining social inequality?
7. Outline and assess some of the consequences of the lack of analysis of elites within mainstream sociology.
8. Is it still possible to talk of “feminism” as a unified project or do we need to use the term “feminisms”?
9. Outline and assess the feminist epistemologist critique of “masculinist” approaches to knowledge.

END OF SECTION A

Candidates must answer **THREE** questions: **ONE** from **SECTION A**, **ONE** from **SECTION B** and **ONE** from **EITHER** Section.

SECTION B:

10. Do we live in a “disciplinary society”? Use the work of Foucault to explain your response.
11. Outline and assess Foucault’s discussions of power in terms of the governance of a population.
12. Du Bois asked: “How does it feel to be a problem?” Outline and assess his response to this question.
13. Using the work of at least two theorists, outline and assess the postcolonial critique of the concept of “the West”.
14. “There are various ways of seeing the world, but they are all linked to questions of power”. Critically analyse this statement.
15. Outline and assess the links between the climate crisis and European modernity.
16. In what ways does ‘Southern theory’ take forward debates in ‘Western’ social theory?
17. Outline and assess some of the limitations of traditional approaches to sexual difference.
18. “Sociology is the study of *human* societies”. Critically analyse the limitations of this statement.

END OF SECTION B

END OF QUESTION PAPER
PLEASE SEE NEXT PAGE FOR THE ANSWER SHEET

ANSWER SHEET
(Please use as many sheets as you need to)

Student Registration Number:

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TYPE THE QUESTION NUMBERS AND YOUR ANSWERS HERE: